MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume IX | Issue II | Spring 2019

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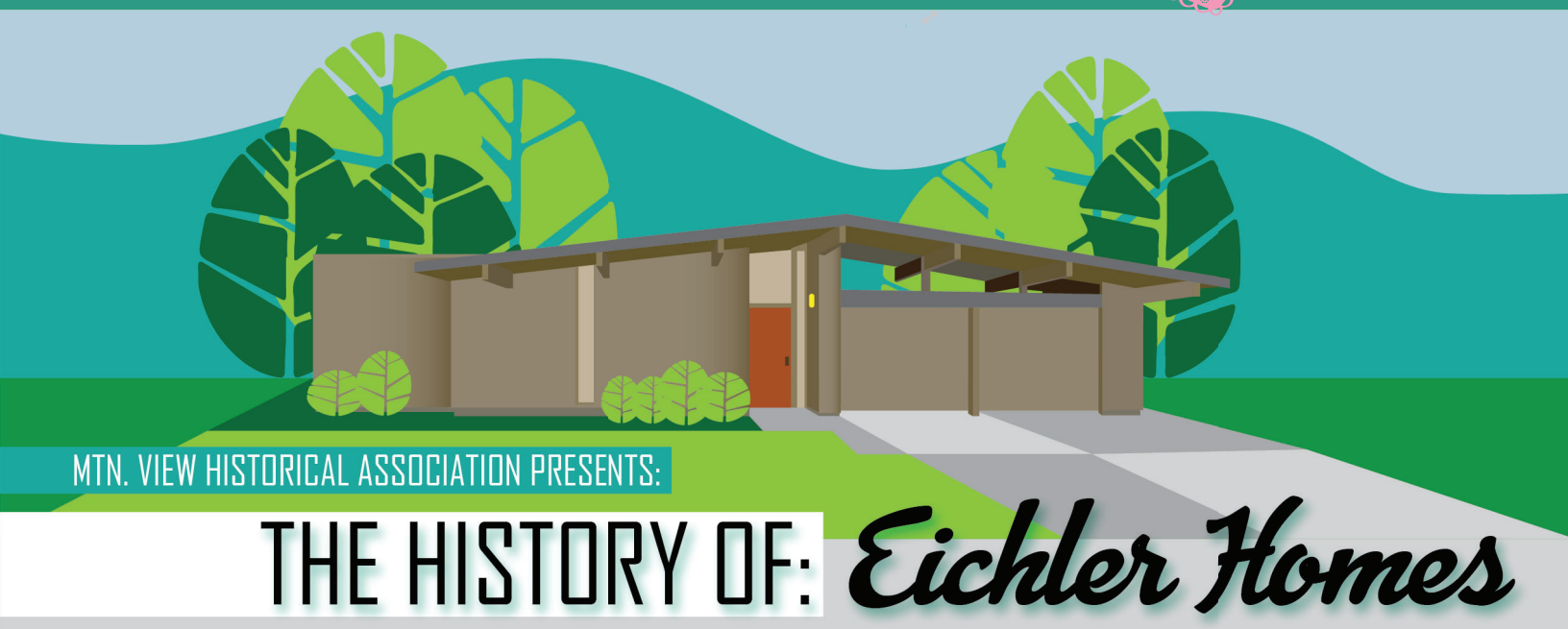




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MTN. VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION PRESENTS:

THE HISTORY OF: *Eichler Homes*

Spring Meeting

ABOUT THE MEETING

Join us as we explore the fascinating history behind California's iconic mid-century modern Eichler homes. Joseph Leopold Eichler was a real estate developer whose distinctive residential subdivisions can be found throughout the state, with approximately 275 in Mountain View alone. The MVHA is excited to welcome special guest speaker Monique Lombardelli, who will share Mr. Eichler's crusade to provide affordable housing in the Bay Area, drastically changing the lives of thousands of families of all backgrounds at a time when racial segregation still created barriers to homeownership for many people.

OUR GUEST SPEAKER



Monique Lombardelli is the broker and CEO of Modern Homes Realty. She has been featured in national magazines like Dwell, Realtor.com, California Home and Design, Curbed, and Architect Magazine for rejuvenating Eichler homes and specializing in modern home sales. With a college degree in film and media, she has produced films about Modernism to educate buyers. Considered an evangelist for mid-century modern style homes, she has done much to revitalize interest in rescuing and preserving their legacy.

SUNDAY, MAY 5, 2019 ● 2:00-4:00 P.M. ● MTN. VIEW PUBLIC LIBRARY COMMUNITY ROOM, 585 FRANKLIN ST., MTN. VIEW, CA

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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News & Notes

President's Message

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA President

Spring is in the air! It's a time of fresh starts and new beginnings. For me this year, that sense of optimism is underscored by the arrival of my brother's first child. My new niece is adorable, wonderful, and perfect, and I'm so excited to be her uncle!

My niece's arrival has prompted me to reflect and wonder what connection she'll feel to Mountain View. Over the past decade, my generation of the family has been priced out of our hometown. Those of us who have begun to raise families of our own are doing so at the edges of the Bay Area where housing is relatively more affordable.

Which brings us to our spring program on Eichler homes. When Joseph Eichler built his subdivisions, his goal was to make modern housing affordable to all people, regardless of race or background. Our guest speaker for our May 5 meeting will share this history with us. I hope you'll come learn more about the role Mr. Eichler played in building Mountain View into the inclusive, affordable, middle-class city that my generation and my parents' generation were so lucky to grow up in.

But Mountain View Eichler homes that originally sold for $13,950–$131,000 in today's dollars–now sell for over $2 million. For decades, housing production has not kept up with job creation. Demand for housing now far exceeds supply and as a result, fewer and fewer people can afford to call Mountain View home. So when I see new housing rise up on the site of an old shopping center or office building, I may mourn losing the physical connection to any memories I made there, but I also understand the need. If done right, we will be building a Mountain View that is able to maintain the diversity that has long-defined its identity.

Nevertheless, it now seems quite likely that my niece's generation of the family will be connected to Mountain View only through our family's history. We have become part of a Mountain View "diaspora." Looking at the addresses in the MVHA membership roster, I know many of you also fall into that same category, which is why I'm glad the MVHA exists. This association provides a way for us to stay connected to the Mountain View community, whether we live near or far. And it also serves as an important bridge between those who live in Mountain View today and those who came before. So whether you just left Mountain View but want to *stay connected*, or whether you just arrived in Mountain View and are looking to feel *more connected* to your new community, this association is here for you!

–Nick

Financial Report

By Emily Ramos
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 12/22/2018: $24,449.81
Income: $907.92
Expenses: $1,455.84
Checking Account Balance as of 4/9/2019: $23,901.89

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 12/30/2018: $60,158.38
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 4/9/2019: $60,229.09

Board Position Open

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA President

Want to help plan the future of the MVHA? Then consider joining our Board of Directors! We have a new vacancy on the Board due to the departure of Regina Sakols, who recently had to step down as our Ways & Means Committee Chair to devote time to other commitments.

The Ways & Means Committee Chair is a position appointed by the MVHA Board's Executive Committee. According to our by-laws, the official duty of the Ways & Means Committee Chair is "to formulate plans for the raising of funds for special projects of the Association." We are looking for someone with creative energy who can help dream up ideas for new projects and who can help us raise the support needed to turn those ideas into reality. If you join the Board, you will be joining a diverse and passionate team. To learn more about the current members of our Board, visit the new "About Us" section of our website at:

https://mountainviewhistorical.org/about/

And if you're interested in joining our team, please email me at:

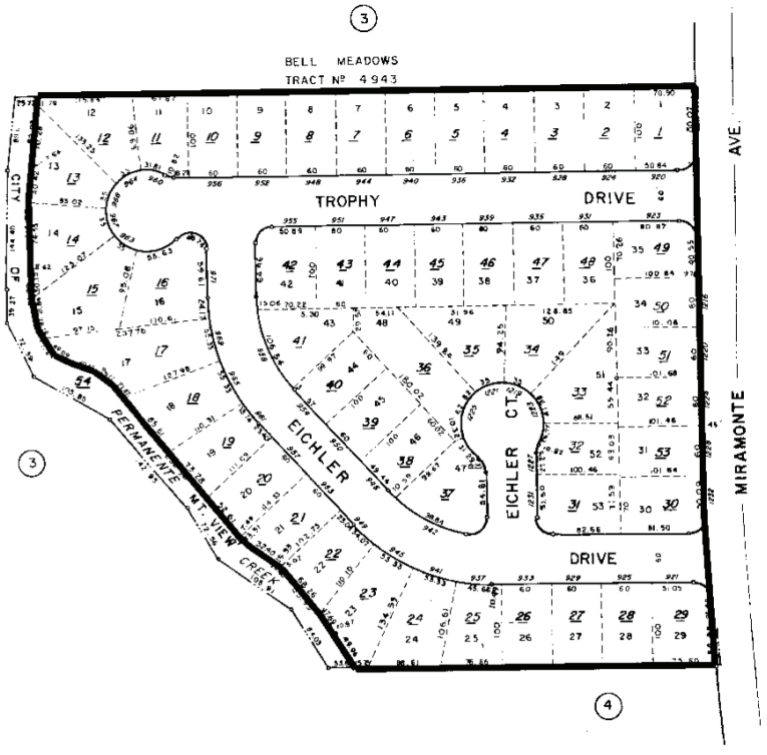
president@mountainviewhistorical.org

Street Talk



Mountain View has two concentrations of Eichler homes. The earlier and larger of the two is the Fairview Tract, built in 1953 and located in the Monta Loma Neighborhood. These homes are located on Quincy Drive, Benjamin Drive, Thaddeus Drive, Dell Avenue, Emmons Drive, Nedson Court, Victory Avenue, Richard Court, Alvin Street, and Thompson Avenue.

The other concentration of Eichler homes in Mountain View is known as the Bell Meadows Tract and can be found just off Miramonte Avenue, north of Marilyn Drive. Built between 1972 and 1973, Bell Meadows features two streets that bear Eichler's name: Eichler Drive and Eichler Court.



Above: Santa Clara County Assessor's parcel map of the Bell Meadows tract in Mountain View

Special Feature

MV Eagles 1975 Football Team Monument Proposal



Editor's Note: *Special newsletter contributor Susan Metcalf is part of a group working to install a monument to the 1975 Mountain View High Eagles football team at Eagle Park. Read on to learn the story of this special team and how they united the community of Mountain View.*

By Susan Cloughley Metcalf
Special Contributor

Mountain View High School, located in the 600 block of Castro Street, was built in 1922. It opened its doors in the fall of 1924 and closed in 1981. The building was demolished in 1987. Today, the site is home to apartments, businesses, and Eagle Park—a popular community hub. The park stands on what used to be Mountain View's football field.

To Navy personnel newly assigned to Moffett Field, the school was advertised as a "cultural melting pot." That was the Navy's "spin" and, perhaps, a more acceptable way of saying it was home to a diverse student population. In the fall of 1975, the senior class was made up of 55% Hispanic, Asian, and Black students and a handful of students of Indian-origin. It was 45% white. According to the Bay Area Census, the median household income was nearly half that of its neighboring cities, like Los Altos. The median household income in Mountain View was about $20,000 per annum.

In the 1970s, Mountain View was not the home of global high-tech companies and the upscale shopping and dining district that it is today. According to comments on the *Mountain View Voice* and my personal experience, Castro Street didn't offer much and wasn't the safest place at night. The downtown was a ghost town on weekends. The main drag sported a number of Chinese restaurants and a Wienerschnitzel on the corner of Castro and California. My parents would let me go to the Mountain View Movie Theater, on Castro Street, only if I was with a group of friends. (The theater closed in 1987 and has since taken on numerous configurations.)

Mountain View High School was a mixture of students from all walks of life and interests. It was culturally divided with prominent groups of Filipinos, Blacks, Hispanics, Whites, and Asians. It was socially divided with groups of jocks, stoners, nerds, bookworms, band kids, theater kids, Navy brats, and student government reps. I don't recall trouble between any of the groups although a few students set the band room on fire in 1974.

The one area where students really came together was on the Eagles football team. The 1975 varsity team had seniors, juniors and a few sophomores. The team was small and its players were not particularly impressive in size. There were few players over six feet tall. Many didn't have much meat on their bones either. Like the school, the team was a melting pot of ethnicities. The team had heart, though. Its motto was "You Gotta Believe," and they did.

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In 1975, the Mountain View Eagles did the unexpected. Called a group of misfits, a Cinderella team and the underdog by the news media, the Eagles took the Santa Clara Valley Athletic League (SCVAL) championship and went on to win the Central Coast Section (CCS) championship—rising above more than 120 schools.

While football brought the Mountain View community together, game by game, it was a tough season. The challenge wasn't so much the physicality of being a small team with small players, but being a racially-mixed team. Mountain View played predominately affluent white teams like Los Altos, St. Francis, Homestead, Leland, and superpower Monte Vista. Racial slurs flew on the field.

And that's where the Eagles' motto played its most important role. "You Gotta Believe." The players didn't let adversity of any kind stand in the way of their goals and dreams. They pushed on, knowing that teamwork, camaraderie, and their collective love of the game would lead them to victory.

The Mountain View Eagles showed the Bay Area that a "cultural melting pot" could not only be highly successful in its chosen path (in this case, football) but also triumph over negativity and discrimination. They were a microcosm of positivity and determination that, perhaps, set an example for what the city of Mountain View has become today.

The team recently held a 40-year anniversary in downtown Mountain View, on Castro Street, of course. Several players flew in from different parts of the United States to celebrate the victories of 1975. Coaches, cheerleaders, and players sat side-by-side, focusing on the good times. When the subject of racial discrimination came up, they all agreed, "That's not why we're here." Today, they are still a very close-knit group. Many still live in Mountain View and have raised their families here.

The theme "You Gotta Believe" resurfaced at the reunion with running back Scotty Hamilton leading the MVHS cheer. Quarterback Denny Mateo had shirts with the imprinted motto available. The theme became Denny's personal motto as he



battled stomach cancer one year later. The team believed, for Denny.

Winning championship games is a huge accomplishment and yes, other teams have won and will win SCVAL and CCS in the future. Their victories are important, too. The Mountain View Eagles' victory, however, was a significant event in the history of the city, especially now that the Castro Street school, the MVHS Eagles teams, and the blue and gray colors are gone. They are all just memories—memories that should not be forgotten.

Today, we have an opportunity to celebrate Mountain View's history and cultural diversity, acknowledge the legacy of Mountain View High School on Castro Street, recognize some remarkable young football players who overcame adversity to prevail, and most importantly, inspire future generations of Mountain View youth, "to believe."



Want to learn more about the proposal to build a monument to the 1975 Mountain View Eagles Football Team at Eagle Park?

Visit: https://75ccschamps.com/

Winter Meeting Photos

Mtn. View Valentine's Social



MVHA Members Mark Perry (left), Larry Leib (center), and Eugene Sharp (right)—all alumni of Mtn. View High's Castro Street campus—pose with an actual piece of their high school that was shared during our show and tell.



Members and guests chat and view objects brought for our show & tell.



MVHA Past President Candace Bowers shares a small piece of the historic "Witness Tree" that once grew near the corner of Grant Road and Cuesta Drive. The Witness Tree was a wild cherry tree that grew on land owned by Benjamin Bubb. It was used by the US Government in an 1865 land survey and was a marker by which early settlers of Mountain View located their land.



MVHA Member Edna Pear demonstrates a piece of farming equipment once used for seeding crops on the Pear Family ranch in Mtn. View.

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name:

Street Address:

City:

State: Zip Code:

Telephone:

E-mail:

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
Mountain View Historical Association
c/o Lisa Garcia
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
Membership Chair

Happy spring everyone!

Please note that on your mailing label we have indicated if you need to renew your membership. If you haven't renewed for 2019, it's not too late! You can either renew online or send in the form attached to the newsletter.

We'd like to welcome Aïda Lecointre and her family as new members! And a big thank you to Dan Rich and Sean O'Malley for renewing as lifetime members!

As always, if you have any questions or concerns you can email mvha.membership@gmail.com or call Lisa Garcia at (323) 705-5650.

Membership as of April 17, 2019

Honored Members	1
Life Members	114
Family Members	64
Single Members	63
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**242**

Thank you all for your membership and support!

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Interested? Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.

SPRING/SUMMER

May 5
Sunday 2:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m.
MVHA Spring Event/Meeting
Mtn.View Public Library, 585 Franklin St.
See front page for details

June 12
Wednesday 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.
MVHA Spring/Summer Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.
All interested members welcome to attend!

August 4
Sunday 12:00 p.m. to 2:00 p.m.
MVHA Summer BBQ
Historic Adobe Building,
More information in our summer newsletter

September 11
Wednesday 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.
MVHA Summer/Fall Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.
All interested members welcome to attend!

Looking Back: Photos from the Archive



The advertisement for the Fairview tract by Eichler Homes ran in the January 15, 1954 edition of the *San Mateo Times*. Learn more about Eichler homes at our Spring Event!

EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
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